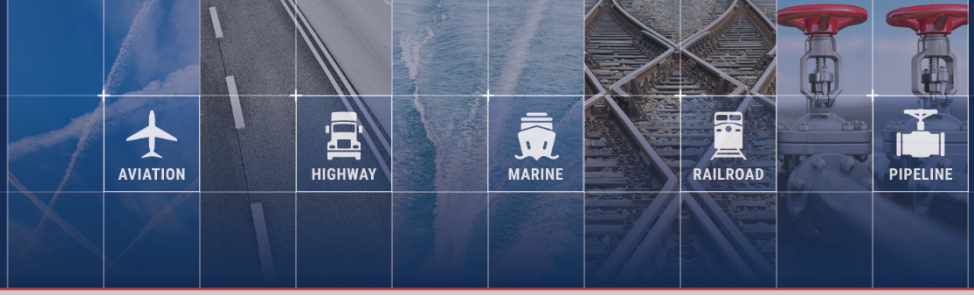

Aviation Investigation Final Report

Location:	Monticello, Iowa	**Accident Number:**	CEN25LA066
Date & Time:	December 28, 2024, 15:00 Local	**Registration:**	N478SA
Aircraft:	DIAMOND AIRCRAFT IND INC DA 40 NG	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:	Wildlife encounter (non-bird)	**Injuries:**	2 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General aviation - Personal		

Analysis

The pilot reported that while in the landing rollout, he saw a deer on the runway and immediately started to apply brakes; however, the deer walked into the airplane. The airplane sustained substantial damage to the left wing. The pilot stated that there were no preaccident failures or malfunctions with the airplane that would have precluded normal operation.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be:

The on-ground collision with a deer on the runway during the landing roll.

Findings

Environmental issues	Animal(s)/bird(s) - Effect on equipment
Environmental issues	Animal(s)/bird(s) - Ability to respond/compensate

Factual Information

History of Flight

Landing-landing roll	Wildlife encounter (non-bird) (Defining event)

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Private	**Age:**	49,Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Single-engine land	**Seat Occupied:**	Left
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Unknown
Instrument Rating(s):	Airplane	**Second Pilot Present:**	Yes
Instructor Rating(s):	None	**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:	BasicMed None	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	May 18, 2023
Occupational Pilot:	No	**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	August 18, 2024
Flight Time:	495 hours (Total, all aircraft), 227 hours (Total, this make and model), 416 hours (Pilot In Command, all aircraft), 16 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 6 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	DIAMOND AIRCRAFT IND INC	**Registration:**	N478SA
Model/Series:	DA 40 NG	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:	2022	**Amateur Built:**	
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	40.NC208
Landing Gear Type:	Tricycle	**Seats:**	5
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	December 5, 2024 Annual	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	2888 lbs
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:	384 Hrs at time of accident	**Engine Manufacturer:**	Austro
ELT:	C91 installed, not activated	**Engine Model/Series:**	E4-A
Registered Owner:	M U D Y PROPERTIES LLC	**Rated Power:**	168 Horsepower
Operator:	M U D Y PROPERTIES LLC	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	Pilot school (141)

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual (VMC)	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	KMXO,849 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	0 Nautical Miles
Observation Time:	14:55 Local	**Direction from Accident Site:**	331°
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	**Visibility**	10 miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	5 knots / None	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	None / None
Wind Direction:	200°	**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	N/A / N/A
Altimeter Setting:	29.89 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	10°C / 8°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Dubuque, IA (DBQ)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	Monticello, IA (MXO)	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	14:00 Local	**Type of Airspace:**	Class E

Airport Information

Airport:	Monticello Regional MXO	**Runway Surface Type:**	Concrete
Airport Elevation:	833 ft msl	**Runway Surface Condition:**	Dry
Runway Used:	15	**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:	4400 ft / 75 ft	**VFR Approach/Landing:**	Touch and go;Traffic pattern

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	2 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	42.220362,-91.163298

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Abraham, Laura
Additional Participating Persons:	Mike Newhall; FAA; IA
Original Publish Date:	April 22, 2025
Last Revision Date:	
Investigation Class:	Class 4
Note:	The NTSB did not travel to the scene of this accident.
Investigation Docket:	https://data.ntsb.gov/Docket?ProjectID=199491

The National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB) is an independent federal agency charged by Congress with investigating every civil aviation accident in the United States and significant events in other modes of transportation—railroad, transit, highway, marine, pipeline, and commercial space. We determine the probable causes of the accidents and events we investigate, and issue safety recommendations aimed at preventing future occurrences. In addition, we conduct transportation safety research studies and offer information and other assistance to family members and survivors for each accident or event we investigate. We also serve as the appellate authority for enforcement actions involving aviation and mariner certificates issued by the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) and US Coast Guard, and we adjudicate appeals of civil penalty actions taken by the FAA.

The NTSB does not assign fault or blame for an accident or incident; rather, as specified by NTSB regulation, "accident/incident investigations are fact-finding proceedings with no formal issues and no adverse parties … and are not conducted for the purpose of determining the rights or liabilities of any person" (Title 49 *Code of Federal Regulations* section 831.4). Assignment of fault or legal liability is not relevant to the NTSB's statutory mission to improve transportation safety by investigating accidents and incidents and issuing safety recommendations. In addition, statutory language prohibits the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report (Title 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b)). A factual report that may be admissible under 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b) is available here.